



THE STUDENT PROMPT STARTER KIT

WRITE BETTER. STUDY SMARTER.
GET BETTER RESULTS.



STUDY SMARTER
Summarize, explain,
and learn faster.



SAVE TIME
Get instant help for
assignments and
projects.



BOOST GRADES
Higher quality
work, better
results.





-  **Understand**
Define your goal clearly. ☒
-  **Context**
Add relevant background. ☒
-  **Details**
Include key requirements. ☒
-  **Format**
Choose the right output. ☒
-  **Review**
Refine for better results. ☒



ESSAY WRITING
Create structured,
clear, and high-
quality essays.



RESEARCH HELP
Find, summarize,
and analyze
information.



EXAM PREP
Get explanations,
practice questions,
and more.



Built for
Students



Works for Any
Subject



Use Anytime,
Anywhere



Trusted by
Smart Learners

LEARN SMARTER | WORK FASTER

Welcome, Student!

This kit gives you everything you need to use AI tools the right way as a student. Not to cheat — but to learn faster, understand harder topics, write better drafts, and study more efficiently. Every template in this kit is designed to help you do your best work.

STEP 1 — Read the formula

Understand how the prompt is structured before you copy it.

STEP 2 — Copy the template

Copy the prompt exactly. Do not paraphrase it.

STEP 3 — Fill the brackets

Replace every [BRACKET] with your actual topic, subject, or details.

STEP 4 — Paste into AI

Use ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or any AI assistant.

STEP 5 — Read and learn

Do not just copy the answer — read it, understand it, then use it.

STEP 6 — Ask follow-up prompts

Use the follow-up prompts in this kit to go deeper on any topic.

KEY TAKEAWAY

AI is a learning tool, not a shortcut.
Use it to understand more — not to skip the understanding.

The Student Prompt Formula

Every great student prompt follows the same structure. Learn this formula once and you can build a perfect prompt for any subject, any assignment, any situation.

ROLE	TOPIC	LEVEL	FORMAT	GOAL
ROLE Tell AI who to act as. Example: Act as a patient teacher / tutor / subject expert / study coach	TOPIC Tell AI exactly what subject or topic. Example: The topic is [SUBJECT]. The specific concept is [CONCEPT].	LEVEL Tell AI your level of understanding. Example: Explain for a [beginner / high school student / university student].	FORMAT Tell AI how to structure the answer. Example: Use: bullet points / a table / numbered steps / a story / examples	GOAL Tell AI what you want to do with this. Example: Help me: understand this / memorize it / write an essay / pass my exam
FULL EXAMPLE Act as a patient biology teacher. Explain the process of photosynthesis to a high school student. Use a real-world example, avoid complex jargon, list the 5 most important points, and create 3 quiz questions at the end.				

Prompts for Understanding Difficult Topics

Struggling to understand something? These prompts get AI to explain anything clearly — in a way that actually makes sense to you.

EXPLAIN LIKE I'M A BEGINNER

Act as a patient and experienced teacher.
Explain [TOPIC] to me like I am a complete beginner.
Use simple language. Avoid technical jargon.
Give me one real-life example I can relate to.
End with the 3 most important things to remember about this topic.

BREAK IT DOWN STEP BY STEP

I am struggling to understand [CONCEPT] in [SUBJECT].
Can you break it down step by step?
Start from the very basics.
Use numbered steps, and check I can follow at each stage.
Give me a simple analogy to help it stick.

EXPLAIN WITH AN ANALOGY

Explain [COMPLEX CONCEPT] using a simple, everyday analogy.
The analogy should relate to something a student would know.
Then explain why the analogy works and where it breaks down.
Finally, summarize the concept in 2-3 plain English sentences.

EXPLAIN THE WHY BEHIND IT

I understand WHAT [CONCEPT] is but I do not understand WHY it works that way.
Explain the reason behind [CONCEPT] in [SUBJECT].
Focus on the underlying logic, not just the surface definition.
Use examples if it helps. Keep it under 200 words.

SIMPLIFY A TEXTBOOK PASSAGE

I need you to simplify this textbook passage for me.
Rewrite it in plain, simple language that a [GRADE/YEAR] student can understand.
Keep all the key information but remove confusing language.
Here is the passage: [PASTE TEXTBOOK TEXT HERE]

CONNECT TO REAL LIFE

Explain how [CONCEPT] from [SUBJECT] is used in real life.
Give 3 specific, practical examples of where this concept appears.
Explain why understanding this concept matters beyond the classroom.
Make it relevant to a student aged [AGE/YEAR].

Study Notes Prompt Templates

Use AI to turn messy lecture notes, textbook chapters, and complex topics into clean, organized study notes you can actually use.

ORGANIZE MY NOTES

Act as a study coach.

Take my raw notes below and reorganize them into clear, structured study notes.

Format as: Main Topic → Key Subtopics → Important Definitions → Key Facts.

Keep all the important information but make it clear and easy to read.

My raw notes: [PASTE YOUR NOTES HERE]

CREATE NOTES FROM A TOPIC

Act as an expert teacher in [SUBJECT].

Create comprehensive study notes on [TOPIC] for a [LEVEL] student.

Include: overview, key concepts (with definitions), important formulas or rules, common examples, things to remember, and common mistakes to avoid.

Format: clear sections with bullet points.

SUMMARIZE A LECTURE OR CHAPTER

Summarize the following [lecture notes / chapter] into a clean study summary.

Include: the main idea in one sentence, 5-7 key points, important vocabulary (with definitions), and anything I should memorize.

Format: organized with clear headings.

Content: [PASTE LECTURE NOTES OR CHAPTER TEXT HERE]

CREATE FLASHCARD CONTENT

Create [X] flashcard question-and-answer pairs about [TOPIC] in [SUBJECT].

The flashcards should test: key definitions, important facts, formulas, and application of concepts. Format each as:

QUESTION: [question]

ANSWER: [clear, concise answer]

MIND MAP OUTLINE

Create a text-based mind map outline for [TOPIC] in [SUBJECT].

Start with the central concept, then branch into 4-6 main subtopics.

Under each subtopic, list 3-4 key points or examples.

This will be used to create a visual mind map for studying.

Essay Writing Prompt Templates

Use AI to plan, structure, and improve your essays — without writing them for you. These prompts make you a better writer, not a copy-paster.

PLAN MY ESSAY

Act as an experienced academic writing tutor.
Help me plan an essay on [ESSAY TOPIC] for [SUBJECT].
The essay should be [X] words long. Level: [HIGH SCHOOL / UNIVERSITY].
Create: a strong thesis statement, 3-5 main arguments with evidence points,
a suggested structure (intro, body paragraphs, conclusion), and a strong hook opening.
Do NOT write the essay — just give me the plan.

IMPROVE MY INTRODUCTION

Read my introduction below and help me improve it.
The essay topic is: [TOPIC]. Subject: [SUBJECT].
Tell me: what works, what is weak, how to make the hook stronger,
and whether my thesis statement is clear. Then rewrite it to show me how.
My introduction: [PASTE YOUR INTRO HERE]

STRENGTHEN MY ARGUMENT

I am writing an essay arguing that [YOUR ARGUMENT].
Help me strengthen this argument by:
1. Identifying 3 strong supporting points
2. Anticipating counterarguments I should address
3. Suggesting types of evidence to look for
4. Checking if my logic is sound
Do not write the essay — help me think through my argument.

IMPROVE MY ESSAY DRAFT

Act as an academic writing tutor. Review my essay draft below.
Subject: [SUBJECT]. Level: [LEVEL].
Give feedback on: argument clarity, paragraph structure, evidence use,
writing style, and transitions. Score each out of 5 and suggest improvements.
My draft: [PASTE YOUR DRAFT HERE]

WRITE A CONCLUSION

Help me write a strong conclusion for my essay on [TOPIC].
My main arguments were: [LIST YOUR MAIN POINTS].
My thesis was: [YOUR THESIS].
The conclusion should: restate the thesis in new words, summarize the
main arguments, and end with a strong closing thought. Under 150 words.

ACADEMIC VOCABULARY

I want to improve the academic language in this paragraph.
Replace informal words with more academic alternatives.
Keep the meaning exactly the same — just make the language more formal.
Do not change the argument or add new ideas.
My paragraph: [PASTE PARAGRAPH HERE]

Before & After: Student Prompts

See the difference between a lazy prompt and a smart one — and how much better your results get when you add just a little more detail.

✗ Weak Prompt Explain the French Revolution.	✓ Better Prompt Act as a history teacher. Explain the French Revolution to a 16-year-old student who has never studied it. Use simple language, cover the 5 main causes, the key events in order, and the 3 most important outcomes. End with 3 exam-style questions.
✗ Weak Prompt Help me study for my exam.	✓ Better Prompt Act as a study coach. I have a [SUBJECT] exam in [X] days. I need to cover [TOPICS]. I can study [HOURS] per day. Create a day-by-day revision plan with specific tasks, topics to cover, and a short quiz at the end of each day.
✗ Weak Prompt Write me an essay plan.	✓ Better Prompt Act as an academic writing tutor. Help me plan a 1,500-word argumentative essay on [TOPIC] for [SUBJECT]. Create: a thesis statement, 3 main arguments with evidence suggestions, counterargument to address, and paragraph structure. Do not write the essay.
✗ Weak Prompt What is mitosis?	✓ Better Prompt Explain mitosis to a biology student who is preparing for an exam. Include: what it is, why cells divide, the 4 stages with what happens in each, a simple diagram description, and 3 common exam questions about mitosis with model answers.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Adding role + level + format to any study prompt transforms a generic answer into a personalized lesson.

Exam Preparation Prompt Templates

Exams are less scary when you prepare smarter. These prompts turn AI into your personal revision coach.

CREATE A REVISION PLAN

Act as a study coach.
Create a revision plan for my [SUBJECT] exam on [DATE].
Topics I need to cover: [LIST YOUR TOPICS].
I have [X] days and [Y] hours per day available.
Include: daily schedule, topics per session, revision technique for each,
and a practice test day before the exam. Format as a table.

PRACTICE EXAM QUESTIONS

Create [X] exam-style questions for [SUBJECT] on the topic of [TOPIC].
Level: [GCSE / A-Level / University / Grade X].
Include: [X] multiple choice, [X] short answer, and [X] longer essay questions.
After each question, provide the model answer so I can check my work.

MOCK EXAM SIMULATION

Act as an examiner for [SUBJECT] at [LEVEL].
Give me a 10-question mock test on [TOPICS].
I will answer each question, and you will:
- Mark my answer out of the available marks
- Tell me what I got right
- Explain what I got wrong and why
- Give me the model answer
Start with Question 1 now.

IDENTIFY MY WEAK AREAS

I just completed a practice test for [SUBJECT]. Here are my answers:
[PASTE YOUR ANSWERS OR DESCRIBE WHERE YOU WENT WRONG]
Analyze my performance. Identify: my weakest topics, the type of questions
I struggled with most, and create a targeted study plan to fix these gaps
before my exam. Be specific and honest.

EXPLAIN A PAST PAPER ANSWER

I got this exam question wrong in my practice paper.
Question: [PASTE QUESTION]
My answer: [PASTE YOUR ANSWER]
Model answer: [PASTE MODEL ANSWER if you have it]
Explain: why my answer was wrong, what the correct reasoning is,
and what I need to understand to get this right next time.

LAST-MINUTE REVISION SUMMARY

I have [X] hours until my [SUBJECT] exam.
Give me the most important things to review for [TOPICS].
Format as: top 10 must-know facts, key formulas or rules to memorize,
common exam traps to avoid, and 5 practice questions with quick answers.

Math & Science Prompt Templates

Struggling with equations, formulas, or scientific concepts? These prompts turn AI into your personal math and science tutor.

SOLVE AND EXPLAIN A PROBLEM

Act as a patient math tutor.

Solve this problem step by step: [PASTE YOUR MATH PROBLEM]

For each step:

- Show what you are doing and why
- Explain the rule or formula being used
- Point out any common mistakes students make at this step

At the end, summarize the method so I can apply it to similar problems.

EXPLAIN A FORMULA OR THEOREM

Explain [FORMULA/THEOREM] in [SUBJECT] to a [LEVEL] student.

Include: what it means in plain English, when and why we use it, a worked example from scratch, and the 2 most common mistakes students make.

Format: clear sections, use simple notation.

CHECK MY WORKING

Check my working for this [MATH/SCIENCE] problem.

The question is: [PASTE QUESTION]

My working and answer: [PASTE YOUR WORKING]

Tell me: is my answer correct? If not, where did I go wrong?

Explain the error clearly so I understand what not to do next time.

CREATE PRACTICE PROBLEMS

Create [X] practice problems on [TOPIC] in [SUBJECT] for a [LEVEL] student.

Make them progressively harder (easy → medium → hard).

After the problems, provide full worked solutions so I can check my answers.

Focus on the types of problems most likely to appear in exams.

SCIENCE CONCEPT VISUALIZED

Describe [SCIENTIFIC CONCEPT] as if you are drawing me a diagram.

Walk me through the visual step by step: what is in the center, what surrounds it, what arrows or labels would be on it, and what each part represents. Help me see it in my mind so I can draw it myself.

UNIT AND FORMULA QUICK GUIDE

Create a quick reference guide for [TOPIC] in [SUBJECT].

Include: all key formulas with what each variable means, units for each quantity, a worked example for each formula, and a memory tip for remembering each one.

History & Humanities Prompt Templates

History, English, Geography, Philosophy — these prompts help you analyze, compare, and write about humanities subjects with depth and confidence.

ANALYZE A HISTORICAL EVENT

Act as a history teacher.

Help me analyze [HISTORICAL EVENT] for my [LEVEL] exam.

Include: causes (short-term and long-term), key events in chronological order, different historical interpretations, consequences, and significance.

Format: structured sections with clear headings.

COMPARE TWO EVENTS OR FIGURES

Compare [PERSON/EVENT A] and [PERSON/EVENT B] in [SUBJECT].

For each: key facts, motivations, methods, and outcomes.

Then: similarities, key differences, and which had more impact and why.

Format: comparison table first, then a written analysis paragraph.

ANALYZE A SOURCE OR TEXT

Act as an expert in [SUBJECT].

Help me analyze this [primary source / text / poem / speech].

Analyze: purpose, audience, tone, key arguments, techniques used, historical or literary context, and reliability (for historical sources).

Source: [PASTE TEXT OR DESCRIBE IT HERE]

ESSAY ARGUMENT BUILDER

Help me build a strong argument for this essay question:

[PASTE YOUR ESSAY QUESTION]

Subject: [SUBJECT]. Level: [LEVEL].

Provide: a clear thesis, 3-4 evidence-based arguments, counterarguments to address, and a list of specific examples, events, or quotes I should research and include.

GEOGRAPHIC CASE STUDY NOTES

Create structured case study notes for [PLACE/EVENT] in Geography.

Include: location and context, key facts and statistics, causes, effects (social, economic, environmental), responses/management, and evaluation.

Format for use as revision notes.

PHILOSOPHY CONCEPT EXPLAINER

Explain [PHILOSOPHICAL CONCEPT/ARGUMENT] in [SUBJECT].

Include: who proposed it and when, the core idea in plain English, the main arguments for it, the main objections against it, and how it is relevant to the [TOPIC] I am studying.

University Student Prompt Templates

University demands higher-level thinking, independent research, and academic writing. These prompts are built for degree-level students.

RESEARCH TOPIC EXPLORER

I am researching [TOPIC] for my [SUBJECT] degree.
Help me explore the academic landscape of this topic.
Include: key debates in the field, major theories or frameworks,
influential academics or papers I should look up,
research gaps that make interesting essay angles,
and 5 specific research questions I could explore.

LITERATURE REVIEW GUIDE

Help me plan a literature review on [TOPIC] for my [SUBJECT] course.
Guide me through: how to structure a literature review, what types of sources
to look for, how to group and compare sources thematically,
what to include in each paragraph, and how to identify research gaps.
Do NOT write the review – help me plan and execute it myself.

CRITICAL ANALYSIS FRAMEWORK

Help me critically analyze [THEORY / ARGUMENT / TEXT] for my university essay.
Walk me through: what the main argument is, its key assumptions,
its strengths, its limitations, counter-arguments from other scholars,
and how I can position my own argument in relation to it.

DISSERTATION SECTION PLANNER

Help me plan the [INTRODUCTION / METHODOLOGY / LITERATURE REVIEW / DISCUSSION]
section of my dissertation on [TOPIC].
My research question is: [YOUR QUESTION].
Tell me: what this section needs to include, how to structure it,
what word count to aim for each part, and common mistakes to avoid.

REFERENCING AND CITATION HELP

Help me understand how to correctly cite [SOURCE TYPE] in [REFERENCING STYLE].
The source is: [DESCRIBE YOUR SOURCE – author, title, year, etc.]
Show me: the correct in-text citation format, the full reference list entry,
and any common mistakes students make with this type of citation.

SEMINAR PREPARATION

I have a seminar on [TOPIC] in [SUBJECT] on [DATE].
Help me prepare by: summarizing the key arguments I should know,
generating 5 discussion questions I could raise or be asked,
suggesting my own critical position I could argue,
and giving me 3 quotes or evidence points to back up my position.

Reading & Comprehension Prompts

Struggling with dense reading material? These prompts help you extract, understand, and remember what you read.

SUMMARIZE A TEXT

Summarize the following text for a [LEVEL] student.
Give me: the main argument in one sentence, 5 key points the author makes, any important vocabulary I should know, and the author's conclusion.
Format: bullet points under clear headings.
Text: [PASTE TEXT HERE]

IDENTIFY THE MAIN ARGUMENT

Read this text and identify the main argument.
Explain: what the author is arguing, what evidence they use, whether the argument is logical or has weaknesses, and what assumptions the author is making.
Text: [PASTE TEXT HERE]

DIFFICULT VOCABULARY EXPLAINER

These words and phrases appear in my [SUBJECT] reading and I do not understand them.
For each word/phrase: give a simple definition, use it in a sentence, and explain how it is being used in this specific context.
Words/phrases: [LIST YOUR WORDS]
Context (optional): [PASTE THE SENTENCE OR PARAGRAPH IF HELPFUL]

READING GUIDE — CHAPTER QUESTIONS

Create a reading guide for [BOOK/CHAPTER/ARTICLE TITLE] in [SUBJECT].
Include: 5 key questions to think about while reading, a note-taking framework to fill in as I read, and 3 things I should be able to explain after finishing the reading.

ACTIVE READING NOTES TEMPLATE

Help me take active notes on this text using the Cornell Notes method.
Main idea, key points, questions I have, and a summary.
Text: [PASTE TEXT OR DESCRIBE TOPIC]

Project & Presentation Prompt Templates

From group projects to class presentations, these prompts help you plan, structure, and deliver standout work.

PROJECT PLAN

Help me plan a [TYPE OF PROJECT] on [TOPIC] for [SUBJECT].
I have [X] weeks and [GROUP SIZE or "I am working alone"].
Create: a project overview, breakdown of key tasks with a timeline,
who is responsible for what (if group), resources I will need,
and success criteria – what does a great finished project look like?

PRESENTATION STRUCTURE

Help me structure a [X]-minute class presentation on [TOPIC] for [SUBJECT].
Include: how many slides to have, what goes on each slide,
how long to spend on each section, what to say in the opening to grab attention,
how to end memorably, and what questions the class might ask.

PRESENTATION SCRIPT OUTLINE

Create a speaking script outline for my [X]-minute presentation on [TOPIC].
Structure: opening hook (30 sec), context (1 min), main points ([X] mins),
conclusion and call to action (1 min).
For each section, give me the key sentences to say – not a full script,
just enough to keep me on track without reading word for word.

GROUP PROJECT MEETING AGENDA

Create a meeting agenda for my group project team on [PROJECT TOPIC].
Meeting duration: [X] minutes. Goals of this meeting: [GOALS].
Include: check-in on progress, key decisions to make today,
task assignments with deadlines, and next steps.
Format: timed agenda.

RESEARCH PLAN FOR A PROJECT

I am researching [TOPIC] for a [TYPE OF PROJECT] in [SUBJECT].
Help me create a research plan.
Include: 5 specific research questions to guide my research,
types of sources to look for (primary, secondary, data),
a 5-step research process to follow,
and how to evaluate whether a source is reliable.

Language Learning Prompt Templates

Learning a new language? These prompts turn AI into your personal language teacher and conversation partner.

PRACTICE CONVERSATION

Act as a native [LANGUAGE] speaker at [BEGINNER / INTERMEDIATE / ADVANCED] level.
Have a conversation with me about [TOPIC] in [LANGUAGE].
After each of my responses: correct any grammar or vocabulary errors,
explain why they are wrong, and teach me the correct version.
Start the conversation now with a simple opener.

GRAMMAR EXPLAINER

Explain [GRAMMAR RULE] in [LANGUAGE] to a [LEVEL] student.
Include: when and why we use this rule, the structure or formula,
3 example sentences (with translation), common mistakes, and
3 practice exercises for me to complete with answers.

VOCABULARY BUILDER

Create a vocabulary list of [X] essential words for [TOPIC] in [LANGUAGE].
For each word: the word, its pronunciation guide, its meaning, gender (if applicable),
an example sentence, and a memory trick to help me remember it.
Group by theme if possible.

TRANSLATE AND EXPLAIN

Translate this [LANGUAGE] text into English and explain it.
For each sentence: provide the translation, explain any tricky grammar,
highlight vocabulary I should learn, and note any cultural context that matters.
Text: [PASTE TEXT HERE]

WRITING CORRECTION

I wrote this in [LANGUAGE]. Please correct my writing.
For each error: show the mistake, explain what is wrong,
give the correct version, and explain the grammar rule.
Then give me an overall score out of 10 for grammar, vocabulary, and style.
My writing: [PASTE YOUR WRITING HERE]

Study Habits & Productivity Prompts

Study smarter, not harder. These prompts help you build better habits, manage your time, and stay motivated throughout the year.

BUILD A STUDY SCHEDULE

Act as a study coach.

Create a weekly study schedule for me.

My subjects: [LIST YOUR SUBJECTS]. Exam dates: [LIST DATES].

Available study hours: [HOURS PER DAY]. Commitments: [SPORTS/WORK/OTHER].

Create: a weekly timetable, recommended study techniques for each subject, and advice on balancing subjects without burning out.

BEAT PROCRASTINATION

I keep procrastinating on [TASK/SUBJECT].

Act as a productivity coach. Help me:

1. Identify why I might be procrastinating (ask me questions)
2. Break this task into 5-minute starter actions
3. Create a "just start" plan for today
4. Give me 3 strategies to stay on task

Be direct and practical – not motivational fluff.

POMODORO STUDY PLAN

Create a Pomodoro study session plan for me to study [TOPIC] for [X] hours.

Structure each 25-minute block with: specific task to focus on, exact output or goal for that block, and the 5-minute break activity.

Include a longer break after every 4 blocks.

Goal: cover [WHAT I NEED TO LEARN] by the end of the session.

HANDLE EXAM STRESS

I am feeling very stressed about my [SUBJECT] exam on [DATE].

Act as a supportive study coach.

Help me with: a realistic final week plan, stress management strategies, what to do the night before and morning of the exam, and how to stay calm if I panic during the exam.

Be practical and kind.

ACCOUNTABILITY CHECK-IN

I want to hold myself accountable for studying [SUBJECT] this week.

My goals are: [LIST YOUR GOALS].

Ask me 5 check-in questions about my progress, then:

- Acknowledge what I achieved
- Identify what I am behind on
- Create a catch-up plan for the remaining days
- Give me one motivational reminder to keep going

Critical Thinking Prompt Templates

The best students do not just memorize — they think. These prompts build your critical thinking, analysis, and evaluation skills.

CHALLENGE MY THINKING

I believe that [YOUR OPINION OR ARGUMENT] about [TOPIC].
Play devil's advocate. Argue the strongest possible case against my position.
Then: tell me the weaknesses in my original argument,
suggest evidence I have not considered,
and help me build a more nuanced, balanced view.

EVALUATE AN ARGUMENT

Evaluate the following argument about [TOPIC].
Identify: the main claim, supporting evidence, assumptions being made,
logical fallacies (if any), what evidence is missing, and how convincing it is overall.
Argument: [PASTE OR DESCRIBE THE ARGUMENT]

DIFFERENT PERSPECTIVES ANALYSIS

Analyze [TOPIC / EVENT / ISSUE] from multiple perspectives.
Include: [X] different stakeholder or ideological viewpoints,
what each group would say and why, where they agree, where they conflict,
and your assessment of which perspective is best supported by evidence.

IDENTIFY BIAS IN A SOURCE

Analyze this source for potential bias.
Consider: who wrote it, when, for what audience, with what purpose.
Identify: what perspective it represents, what it might be leaving out,
any loaded language or emotional appeals, and how reliable it is as evidence.
Source: [PASTE SOURCE OR DESCRIBE IT]

SOCRATIC METHOD — DEEP QUESTIONING

Use the Socratic method to help me think more deeply about [TOPIC/QUESTION].
Ask me a series of probing questions one at a time.
After each of my answers, ask a deeper follow-up question.
The goal is to help me discover insights and gaps in my understanding myself.
Start with the first question now.

Before & After: Writing Prompts

Watch how a better prompt turns a generic writing tip into a personalized, detailed response that actually helps.

✗ Weak Prompt Help me with my essay.	✓ Better Prompt Act as an academic writing tutor. Review my essay on [TOPIC] for [SUBJECT] at [LEVEL]. Give feedback on: argument strength (score /5), structure (score /5), evidence use (score /5), and writing quality (score /5). For each score, explain what I did well and what to improve. Then rewrite my weakest paragraph as an example.
✗ Weak Prompt How do I start my essay?	✓ Better Prompt Help me write a strong introduction for my essay on [TOPIC] for [SUBJECT]. My thesis is: [YOUR THESIS]. Create 3 different opening hooks I could use: a surprising statistic, a challenging question, and a relevant quote or scenario. Then show me how to connect the hook to my thesis.
✗ Weak Prompt Improve my writing.	✓ Better Prompt Improve the academic language in the paragraph below from my [SUBJECT] essay. Replace informal phrases with formal academic alternatives, improve sentence variety, and strengthen the argument. Do NOT change the meaning or add new ideas. My paragraph: [PASTE PARAGRAPH]

KEY TAKEAWAY

Specific prompts get specific help.
Vague prompts get vague advice that does not actually improve your work.

Using AI Ethically as a Student

AI tools are powerful — but using them the wrong way can harm your learning and get you in trouble. Here is how to use AI honestly, ethically, and in a way that actually makes you smarter.

THE RIGHT WAY TO USE AI

- ✓ Use AI to understand a concept you are stuck on
- ✓ Use AI to improve your own draft — not replace it
- ✓ Use AI to create study notes from your own raw notes
- ✓ Use AI to practice exam questions and check your answers
- ✓ Use AI to get feedback on your writing before submitting
- ✓ Use AI to explain feedback your teacher gave you

THE WRONG WAY TO USE AI

- X Submitting AI-generated text as your own work
- X Using AI to write essays without understanding the content
- X Copying AI answers without reading or thinking about them
- X Using AI during closed-book exams (unless permitted)
- X Using AI to generate fake research sources or citations
- X Relying on AI so much you stop developing your own skills

HOW TO USE AI AND STILL LEARN

- Use AI as a tutor, not a ghostwriter
- Always read and understand AI explanations before moving on
- Write your first draft yourself — then use AI to improve it
- Ask AI to explain WHY, not just WHAT — test yourself after
- Check AI facts with real sources (Perplexity, Google Scholar)
- Keep a record of what you used AI for — stay transparent

WHAT SCHOOLS ARE DOING IN 2026

- Most schools now use AI detection software on submitted work
- Many exams are moving back to handwritten or supervised formats
- AI use policies vary — always check your school's specific rules
- Being caught submitting AI work can result in serious academic consequences
- The students succeeding with AI are using it to learn — not to skip learning

Quick Prompt Formula Cards

Use these one-line formula cards as quick starters. Just swap the brackets and you are ready.

For Understanding

U1 Explain [TOPIC] to me like I am a [YEAR/AGE] student with no background knowledge.

U2 What is [CONCEPT]? Give me a simple definition, one example, and one analogy.

U3 What are the 5 most important things to know about [TOPIC] for my exam?

U4 Why does [PHENOMENON] happen? Explain the underlying reason, not just the description.

U5 Explain the difference between [A] and [B] in [SUBJECT] with examples.

For Writing & Essays

W1 Give me 5 possible arguments for the essay question: [PASTE QUESTION]

W2 What is wrong with this thesis statement and how can I improve it? [PASTE THESIS]

W3 What types of evidence should I use to support the argument that [YOUR ARGUMENT]?

W4 Rewrite this sentence to sound more academic without changing the meaning: [SENTENCE]

W5 What counterargument would a critic make against my essay's main claim?

For Exam Prep

E1 Quiz me on [TOPIC] in [SUBJECT]. Ask one question at a time and tell me if I am right.

E2 What are the 3 most common mistakes students make on [TOPIC] exam questions?

E3 Give me a model answer for this exam question: [PASTE QUESTION] ([X] marks)

E4 Create a memory trick (mnemonic) to help me remember [LIST OF FACTS].

E5 I have [X] hours until my exam. What are the absolute most important things to review?

Follow-Up Prompts — Go Deeper

The first AI response is never the best one. Use these follow-up prompts after any initial response to go deeper, get clearer, and get more useful answers.

When the explanation is unclear:

C1 That was too complicated. Explain it in even simpler language.

C2 Give me a more concrete real-world example — something from daily life.

C3 Can you break that down into smaller steps? I got lost at step [X].

C4 Explain it as if you are talking to a 12-year-old. Use really simple words.

When you want to go deeper:

D1 Now explain the more advanced version of this concept.

D2 What are the exceptions or edge cases to this rule?

D3 How does this connect to [RELATED TOPIC] that I am also studying?

D4 What would an expert or academic say about this that goes beyond the textbook?

When you want to test yourself:

T1 Now quiz me on everything you just taught me. Ask 5 questions one at a time.

T2 Give me an exam question on this topic and mark my answer.

T3 What question would a teacher most likely ask about this in an exam?

T4 Give me a practice problem based on what we just covered and check my working.

When you want to improve your writing:

R1 Make this more concise without losing any important information.

R2 Improve the academic language and make it more formal.

R3 What is the weakest sentence in this paragraph and how can I fix it?

R4 Make this argument more persuasive with stronger evidence and vocabulary.

Subject-Specific Prompt Starters

Quick one-line starters for common school and university subjects. Just fill in the brackets.

BIOLOGY

- Explain the process of [BIOLOGICAL PROCESS] step by step with a diagram description.
- What is the function of [ORGAN/CELL/STRUCTURE] and how does it work?
- Compare [ORGANISM A] and [ORGANISM B] — similarities, differences, and evolutionary context.
- Create revision notes on [TOPIC] for my [LEVEL] biology exam.

CHEMISTRY

- Balance this chemical equation and explain the reaction: [EQUATION]
- Explain why [ELEMENT/COMPOUND] has these properties based on its structure.
- Walk me through the mechanism of [REACTION TYPE] with a visual description.
- Create practice problems on [TOPIC] with worked solutions.

PHYSICS

- Explain [PHYSICS CONCEPT] using an everyday real-world example.
- Help me solve this physics problem step by step: [PROBLEM]
- Explain the difference between [CONCEPT A] and [CONCEPT B] in physics.
- Create a quick formula reference for [TOPIC] with example calculations.

ENGLISH LITERATURE

- Analyze how [AUTHOR] uses [TECHNIQUE] in [TEXT] to convey [THEME].
- Compare [CHARACTER A] and [CHARACTER B] in [TEXT] — character, motivation, role.
- What are the key themes of [TEXT] and how are they presented?
- Help me write a paragraph analyzing [QUOTE] from [TEXT].

MATHEMATICS

- Explain [MATHS CONCEPT] step by step with 3 worked examples.
- I am stuck on this problem — walk me through it: [PROBLEM]
- Create [X] practice questions on [TOPIC] from easy to hard with solutions.
- What is the most common mistake students make on [TOPIC] questions?

ECONOMICS

- Explain [ECONOMIC THEORY/CONCEPT] with a real-world example from 2024-2026.
- Analyze the impact of [ECONOMIC EVENT/POLICY] using economic theory.
- Draw a diagram description of [MARKET/MODEL] and explain each part.
- Compare [ECONOMIC SYSTEM A] and [ECONOMIC SYSTEM B] — theory, practice, outcomes.

Best Free AI Tools for Students 2026

You do not need to spend money to use powerful AI tools as a student. Here are the best free options and what to use each one for.

CHATGPT (Free Tier)

Best for: general explanations, essay planning, brainstorming, coding help.
Free tier gives you: access to GPT-4o mini (capable for most study tasks).
Tip: use the free tier for daily tasks — upgrade if you need faster, longer responses.
Link: chat.openai.com

CLAUDE (Free Tier)

Best for: long essay feedback, nuanced explanations, reading complex texts.
Free tier gives you: Claude Sonnet — excellent for academic writing tasks.
Tip: Claude gives the most detailed, careful writing feedback of any free AI.
Link: claude.ai

GEMINI (Free)

Best for: research with real sources, quick facts, Google Drive integration.
Free tier gives you: Gemini 1.5 Flash — fast and good for daily questions.
Tip: use Gemini inside Google Docs to get AI help on your actual documents.
Link: gemini.google.com

PERPLEXITY AI (Free)

Best for: research, fact-checking, finding real sources for essays.
Free tier gives you: web-search AI with citations — far better than Googling.
Tip: always click the sources to verify — do not just copy Perplexity's answer.
Link: perplexity.ai

NOTION AI (Free Tier)

Best for: organizing notes, summarizing, building a study system.
Free tier gives you: limited AI responses inside Notion.
Tip: set up a Notion workspace for each subject and use AI to organize notes.
Link: notion.so

PHOTOMATH / WOLFRAM ALPHA

Best for: checking math working, step-by-step solutions, graphing.
Free tier gives you: most features for free.
Tip: use these to check your own working — not to skip doing it.
Link: photomath.com / wolframalpha.com

Common Student Prompt Mistakes

These are the mistakes that stop students from getting useful answers from AI. Fix them and your results will improve immediately.

1. Too vague — no subject or context

MISTAKE: "Explain the causes of the war."

FIX: Specify the war, your level, and what you need: "Explain the 5 main causes of World War 1 for a GCSE history student. Focus on MAIN and ACE causes."

RESULT: Specific, relevant, usable answer.

2. Not telling AI your level

MISTAKE: Getting a university-level response when you need a high school one.

FIX: Always add "for a [YEAR / LEVEL / AGE] student" to your prompt.

EXAMPLE: "...for a Year 11 GCSE student" or "for a first-year university student."

3. Asking AI to do your homework

MISTAKE: "Write my essay on [TOPIC]." — then submitting it as your own.

FIX: "Help me plan my essay" or "Give me feedback on my draft."

RESULT: You learn. You improve. And you are not risking academic misconduct.

4. Not asking for examples

MISTAKE: Getting a dry definition with no examples and not understanding it.

FIX: Always add "give me a real-world example" or "show me how this works in practice."

RESULT: Abstract concepts suddenly click when you see them applied.

5. Not following up

MISTAKE: Accepting the first response even when it is confusing or incomplete.

FIX: Ask "Can you explain that more simply?" or "Give me a different example."

RESULT: You keep going until you actually understand — that is real learning.

6. Not checking facts

MISTAKE: Copying AI facts, statistics, or quotes without verifying them.

FIX: Use Perplexity AI or Google Scholar to verify anything specific.

RESULT: Your work is accurate and you do not get caught using made-up citations.

Student Prompt Quality Checklist

Run every study prompt through this checklist before sending. The more boxes you tick, the better your answer will be.

- ☐ Did I give a clear subject and topic?
- ☐ Did I tell AI my level (year/grade/age)?
- ☐ Did I specify what I want (explanation/notes/quiz)?
- ☐ Did I tell AI the format I want?
- ☐ Did I say what I already know (to avoid repetition)?
- ☐ Did I ask for examples?
- ☐ Am I asking one clear question, not five at once?
- ☐ Did I avoid asking AI to just do my homework for me?
- ☐ Is my prompt specific enough to get a useful answer?
- ☐ Am I ready to follow up if the answer is unclear?

Study Prompt Upgrade Formula

If your first answer was not useful, upgrade your prompt:

Add ROLE

"Act as a [SUBJECT] teacher who..."

Add LEVEL

"...for a [YEAR/GRADE/AGE] student"

Add FORMAT

"...using bullet points / a table / step-by-step"

Add GOAL

"...I need this to prepare for my exam / write my essay"

Add LIMIT

"...in under 200 words / in simple language / without jargon"

Master Student Prompt Reference

Bookmark this page. Everything you need in one place — the master template, the formula, and 20 ready-to-use starters.

THE MASTER STUDENT PROMPT TEMPLATE

Act as a [patient teacher / subject expert / study coach].
Explain / Help me with [SPECIFIC TOPIC] in [SUBJECT].
I am a [YEAR/GRADE/LEVEL] student.
My goal is to [understand this / write an essay / pass my exam / take notes].
Format the answer as [bullet points / table / step-by-step / examples].
Use simple language. Avoid jargon.
Include [examples / a quiz / key points / a summary] at the end.

20 Go-To Student Prompt Starters

01 Explain [TOPIC] to me like I am a beginner. Use simple language and one example.

02 Create revision notes on [TOPIC] for my [SUBJECT] exam.

03 Quiz me on [TOPIC]. Ask one question at a time and tell me if I am right.

04 Help me plan an essay on [TITLE]. Subject: [SUBJECT]. Level: [LEVEL].

05 Give me feedback on this paragraph from my essay: [PASTE PARAGRAPH]

06 Create [X] exam-style questions on [TOPIC] with model answers.

07 Summarize this lecture/chapter into 5 key bullet points: [PASTE TEXT]

08 Explain the difference between [A] and [B] in [SUBJECT] with examples.

09 Create flashcard Q&As for [TOPIC]. Format: QUESTION: / ANSWER:

10 I got this exam question wrong. Explain what the correct answer is: [PASTE]

11 What are the 5 most important things to know about [TOPIC] for my exam?

12 Help me understand why [CONCEPT] works this way in [SUBJECT].

13 Create a [X]-day revision plan for my [SUBJECT] exam. Topics: [LIST].

14 Give me a real-world example of how [CONCEPT] is used outside the classroom.

15 Check my working for this [MATH/SCIENCE] problem: [PASTE QUESTION + WORKING]

16 Simplify this textbook passage so I can understand it: [PASTE TEXT]

17 Help me write a strong conclusion for my essay on [TOPIC].

18 What are the common mistakes students make in [TOPIC] exams and how do I avoid them?

19 Create a memory trick (mnemonic) to help me remember [LIST/PROCESS].

20 Before you answer, ask me what I already know so you can teach at the right level.

The best students do not use AI to skip the work.
They use AI to do the work better.
Start smart. Stay curious. Keep improving.